UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2014

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **(Exam date : 24.08.2014)** **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Vedic Age

1. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India is taken from -
(a) Katha Upanishad
(b) Chandogya Upanishad
(c) Aitareya Upanishad
(d) Mundaka Upanishad

Ans. (d): Satyameva Jayate is the national motto of India. It is inscribed in the Devanagari script at the base of the national emblem, an adaptation of the Lion Capital of Ashoka at Sarnath, near Varanasi, the north Indian state of Uttar Pradesh. The origin of the motto is mantra 3.1.6 from the Mundaka Upanishad.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata, Shaiva and Other Religion

2. Which of the following Kingdoms were associated with the life of the Buddha ?
1. Avanti 2. Gandhara
3. Kosala 4. Magadha
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1,3 and 4

Ans. (c): Both the kingdoms of Magadha and Kosala were related to Gautama Buddha's life. His mother was a princess from the Kosala dynasty. Both the kingdoms of Avanti and Gandhara were not directly related to the life of Buddha.

3. With reference to Buddhist history, tradition and culture in India, consider the following pairs :

Famous shrine	Location
1. Tabo monastery and temple complex	Spiti Valley
2. Lhotsava Lhakhang Temple, Nako	Zanskar Valley
3. Alchi temple complex	Ladakh

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched ?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): Tabo monastery and temple complex is located in the Tago village of Spiti valley, Himachal Pradesh. Lhotsava Lhakhang temple is situated in Nako village in the Kinnaur district of Himachal Pradesh. Aichi temple complex is situated in the Aichi village of Ladakh, lies about 65 km from Leh on the banks of the Indus River.

4. Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy?
(a) Mimamsa and Vedanta
(b) Nyaya and Vaisheshika
(c) Lokayata and Kapalika
(d) Sankhya and Yoga

Ans. (c): Mimansa, Vedanta, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Sankhya and Yoga are part of Indian Philosophies. These six systems of philosophy are said to have been founded by sages Konada, Gotama, Kapila, Patanjali, Jaimini and Vyasa, respectively. Lokayata and Kapalika are not a part of Indian Philosophy.

5. With reference to the Indian history of art and culture, consider the following pairs :

Famous work of sculpture		Site
1. A grand image of Buddha's Mahaparinirvana with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below.	-	Ajanta
2. A huge image of Varaha Avatar (boar incarnation) of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock.	-	Mount Abu
3. ''Arjuna's Penance''/ Descent of Ganga'' sculpted on the Surface of huge boulders.	-	Mamallapuram

Which of the pairs given above is /are correctly matched?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): The Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha in cave 17 of Ajanta, with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below, is one of the grandest and yet most delicately expressive scenes ever made in stone.
The Udayagiri caves are 20 rock-cut caves near Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh from the early years of the 5th century CE. They contain a huge image of Varaha Avatar. Arjuna's Penance is one of the magnificent monuments of Mahabalipuram.

6. With reference to the cultural history of India, the term 'Panchayatan' refer to-
(a) An assembly of village elders
(b) A religious sect
(c) A style of temple construction
(d) An administrative functionary

Ans. (c) Panchayatana is a temple construction style with a central shrine surrounded by four other shrines. It has the main shrine which is surrounded by four subsidiary shrines. The origin of the name is the Sanskrit words Pancha(five) et ayatana (containing). Some of the examples of this style of temples are Lakshmana temple in Khajuraho, Lingaraja temple in Bhubaneswar, etc.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

7. In medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for-
(a) Military officers
(b) Village headman
(c) Specialist in Vedic rituals
(d) Chiefs of craft guilds

Ans. (b): In medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for village headmen. The Headmen is the leader of the community in that village, who owned most of the land.

• Bhakti Movement

8. Consider the following statements :
1. 'Bijak' is a composition of the teachings of Saint Dadu Dayal.
2. The Philosophy of Pushti Marg was propounded by Madhavacharya.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d): Vallabhacharya's philosophy came to be known as Pushtimarga (the path of grace). Kabir's ideas were later collected and preserved in Bijak.

• Mughal Empire

9. Ibadat Khana at Fatehpur Sikri was-
(a) the mosque for the use of Royal Family.
(b) Akbar's private prayer chamber.
(c) the hall in which Akbar held discussions with scholars of various religions.
(d) the room in which the nobles belonging to different religions gathered to discuss religion.

Ans. (c): The Ibadat Khana (House of Worship) was a meeting house built in 1575 by the Mughal Emperor Akbar at Fatehpur Sikri to gather spiritual leaders of different religious grounds so as to conduct a discussion on the teachings of the respective religious leaders.

MODERN HISTORY

• Major Institutions, Treaties, Commissions, Acts, Pacts

10. The Radcliffe Committee was appointed to-
(a) Solve the problem of minorities in India
(b) Give effect to the Independence Bill
(c) Delimit the boundaries between India and Pakistan
(d) Enquire into the riots in East Bengal

Ans. (c) On 17th August 1947, the Radcliffe Line was declared as the boundary between India and Pakistan, following the Partition of India. In June 1947, Britain commissioned Sir Cyril Radcliffe to head the two Boundary (one for Punjab and the other for Bengal), to determine which territories will be assigned to which nation. The boundary commission was asked to demarcate areas in Punjab based on religious majority.

11. What was/were the object/ objects of Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1858)?
1. To disclaim any intention to annex Indian State.
2. To place the Indian administration under the British Crown.
3. To regulate East India Company's trade with India.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1,2 and 3

Ans. (a): The object of Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1858) were to disclaim any intention to annex Indian states as the announcement reversed Lord Dalhousie's pre-war policy of political unification through princely state annexation. It was also to place the Indian administration under the British Crown. Therefore statements (1) and (2) are correct. However, it was not to regulate East India Company's trade with India. So, statement (3) is wrong.

• Freedom Struggle and National Movement

12. The Partition of Bengal made by Lord Curzon in 1905 lasted until –
(a) The First World War when Indian troops were needed by the British and the partition was ended
(b) King George V abrogated Curzon's Act at the Royal Durbar in Delhi in 1911
(c) Gandhiji launched his Civil Disobedience Movement
(d) The Partition of India in 1947 when East Bengal became East Pakistan

Ans. (b) : Lord Curzon, the Viceroy of India, announced the decision to partition Bengal on 20th July 1905 and the partition came into effect from 16th October 1905. A durbar was held in Delhi to welcome British emperor George V and Queen Mary on their arrival in India in December 2011. In the same Delhi Durbar on 12th December 1911, the British emperor announced the cancellation of the partition of Bengal and made Delhi the new capital instead of Calcutta.

13. The 1929 Session of Indian National Congress is of significance in the history of the Freedom Movement because the-
(a) Attainment of Self- Government was declared as the objective of the Congress.
(b) Attainment of Poorna Swaraj was adopted as a goal of the Congress.
(c) Non-Cooperation Movement was launched.
(d) Decision to participate in the Round Table Conference in London was taken.